

Disney Stunt Robot

The next from Disney's Imagineering R&D department is autonomous stunt double robots. Animatronics have been a part of Disney's theme parks for years. This means that the designers at Disney's Imagineering R&D department have to think about both innovation and reliability, so that their innovations are able to continue doing what they're doing for years to come. Due to this, for the most part, Disney animatronics are usually heavy, complex machines that aren't going to be moving from their spot anytime soon. Going from that to stunt robot doubles seems like a complete 180.

Tony Dohi, Principal R&D Imagineer, points out that as the number of characters under Disney keeps expanding, you've got Star Wars, Pixar, and even Marvel, most of these characters are very active on-screen. An agile stunt animatronic would be able to do something more entertaining for audiences at shows to better depict these characters.



A new division, Stuntronics, took up the task of building the stuntbots. What they've done so far is already impressive, with humanoid robots which can swing off ropes, strike cool poses, and even correct their trajectory and strike poses mid-air. Creepy or cool?

8BitDo Wireless DIY Kits

When it comes to anything retro gaming, 8BitDo is a familiar name. This time, they've come up with DIY kits which you can use to make your original retro controllers wireless. Now considering you can buy these controllers and wireless adapters for the same from the company directly, why would you want to purchase this kit? Well, for starters, it's \$20. Considerable cheaper than buying a wireless variant. Secondly, many may not want to part ways with their original consoles and controllers. Using the 8BitDo DIY kit, you get to keep the old controller, while still enjoying a wireless experience.

Basically, the DIY kit involves you replacing the inside of your controller with a new board that supports wireless connectivity. This simply involves you opening the controller up, which shouldn't be too hard, then removing the PCB, (you don't have to toss it, you can hold on to it, in case you might not be comfortable with the new set up, you can just go back to your good old wired setup) and pop in the new one. As of right now, there are conversion kits for the NES and the SNES, the new classic editions for both, and the SEGA Genesis/Mega Drive.



Opener BlackFly

California-based startup Opener, officially debuted its flying car the BlackFly, recently, which they're calling "the world's first ultralight all-electric fixed-wing vertical take-off and landing (VTOL) aircraft." The single-seat car/aircraft does not require the driver to have a pilot's license, but in order to fly the BlackFly, you will be required to complete a FAA Private Pilot written exam. This is in addition to a company-mandated vehicle familiarisation and operator training program.



According to Opener, the BlackFly should be able to travel distances of up to 40 kilometers and reach a top speed of up to 100 kilometers per hour. It will also support a Super Charging option which means it'll take the BlackFly less than half an hour to fully charge itself. They also promise a low noise signature. For safety, owners will be able to geofence their BlackFly, making sure it stays within a predetermined radius. Other than that, there is also an emergency return-to-home button and a ballistic parachute.